



# Soknarith (Soki) Sem

☎ (401) 952-6819 — ✉ [seminaia401@gmail.com](mailto:seminaia401@gmail.com) — 🌐 [Seminaia](#) — in [soknarith-sem](#) — 📍 Worcester, MA

## SUMMARY

Materials and process engineer with experience in process optimization, manufacturing support, statistical process control, SOP development, Lean/Six Sigma principles. Skilled in process scale-up, troubleshooting, CAPA implementation, and cross-team technical transfer. Proficient in data-driven analysis and modeling to improve process performance and product quality, with strong hands-on experience in lab and pilot-scale operations. Very Familiar with various scientific computing tools including Python, MATLAB/Simulink, ASPEN Plus Dynamics, and R for data analysis and process modeling.

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### Research Assistant / Graduate Teaching Assistant

May 2024 to Present

Worcester Polytechnic Institute – Worcester, MA

- Quantified defect energetics and transport behavior in oxide perovskites using DFT and thermodynamic modeling.
- Analyzed structure–property–process relationships across temperature and chemical potential regimes.
- Assisted in teaching undergraduate and graduate materials engineering courses by grading assignments and leading homework help sessions.

### Chemical Process Engineer

May 2023 to May 2024

Knowles Precision Devices – New Bedford, MA

- Led the installation of new impregnation systems for high-voltage capacitors.
- Read P&ID and process flow diagrams to ensure proper equipment setup and process flow.
- Applied LEAN/Six-Sigma/5S principles and statistical process controls in order to operate within KPI targets.
- Authored SOPs, technical documentation, safety protocols for material handling and process scale-up.
- Mentored technicians and operators on process procedures, safety protocols, and quality standards.
- Performed root cause analysis on batch failures, including CAPA implementation and process improvement suggestions.
- Modeled heater behavior in order to quantify the length of time required to reach target temperatures and pressures.

### R&D Technician

Mar 2023 to May 2023

Factorial Energy – Woburn, MA

- Fabricated Li-metal batteries in controlled glovebox and dry-room environments.
- Reduced material waste by 20% through inventory system redesign.

### Downstream Purification Engineer

Jul 2022 to Mar 2023

Eurofins Scientific – Framingham, MA

- Purified therapeutic proteins using AKTA Avant systems achieving 95–99% purity.
- Applied DOE methods to optimize buffer conditions and flow rate for maximum yield and purity at lab-scale.
- Performed lab-scale TFF membrane filtration and AKTA chromatography resin life-time studies to validate CIP protocols.
- Characterized purified proteins using SDS-PAGE, HPLC/MS, GC/MS, UV-Vis, and related analytical techniques.

## EDUCATION

### M.S. Materials Science & Engineering

Worcester Polytechnic Institute – Worcester, MA

2024 to 2026

### B.S. Chemical Engineering; B.S. Applied Mathematics

University of Rhode Island – Kingston, RI

2019 to 2022

**Minors:** Chemistry, Physics

**Relevant Coursework:** Advanced Process Engineering, Polymer Chemistry, Polymer Engineering, Heat Transfer, Fluid Mechanics

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

|                                 |                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Atomistic Simulation:</b>    | DFT (VASP & GPAW), Molecular Dynamics (LAMMPS)                                                                                                |
| <b>Scientific Computing:</b>    | Python, MATLAB/Simulink, ASPEN Plus Dynamics, Linux, LaTeX, R, Unicorn                                                                        |
| <b>Laboratory / Analytical:</b> | Glovebox, clean-room, HPLC, AKTA FPLC, TFF, SEM/XRD, DSC/TGA, UV-Vis, Osmometry, HPLC/MS, GC/MS, pH meter, SDS-PAGE, KF coulometric titration |
| <b>Process / Manufacturing:</b> | SPC, DOE, Lean/Six Sigma (Certification in progress), Process optimization, SOP development, Tech Transfer (MSAT), cGMP                       |